Driving Meaningful User Engagement

*How **Jar** can turn passive saving into lasting user value*



CASEBLITZ

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Jar

Make small savings visible and purposeful, without changing how saving works.

THE PROBLEM:

UPI → Round-off → Gold → Automatic Saving → Nothing brings the user back

Once passive saving is set up, the user doesn't need to do anything inside Jar.

35M registered users, 95% first-time savers

What we found:

- Saving is triggered in UPI apps, not in Jar.
- Users can't see how small savings add up.
- Round-off is not unique to Jar (Gullak offers it too).
- Jar-powered saving is already inside PhonePe.
- Some reviews raise concerns on transparency, charges and spreads.

Root cause: Jar removed the need to act, and with it the reason to return.

The recommendation

- Two connected moves. A home screen widget puts progress where the user already looks.
- A Goal Progress Engine gives the savings a purpose. Both run on unchanged round-off.

The user journey

- Aarav pays by UPI, round-off happens, the widget shows 72% of his goal, he taps in, then sets his next goal.
- Target: 2-3 meaningful opens a week (weekly story, milestone, gold price check). Footnote it as an assumed rhythm.

Protects the saving habit

- Round-off logic untouched. Widget is opt-in and display-only.
- No new push notifications.
- Each tap deep-links to a useful screen.

Metrics to track

- Meaningful opens per user per week (target 2-3), widget-to-app click-through, goal creation rate.
- Guardrail: round-off opt-out rate stays flat.

Business impact

- +10% Active Users → larger engaged user base
- +15.5% Savings Flow → higher total savings generated
- +15.5% Revenue → increased monetization from existing users
- +15.5% Contribution Profit → improved unit economics
- Higher Retention → stronger long-term customer value
- Scalable Growth → more value from the existing user base

Key diagnosis: Jar removed the need to act; and also the reason to return.

CURRENT USER JOURNEY

Payment Trigger
User makes a daily purchase via UPI scan or card payment.

Trigger outside the app
Trigger lives in UPI apps (PhonePe, GPay etc.) during daily checkout flows.

Round-off
Transaction amount is rounded to nearest ₹10 or ₹100 automatically.

No action needed
Completely passive habit requiring zero cognitive load once configured.

Gold Purchase
Spare change is seamlessly and automatically invested in digital gold.

No immediate reward
Savings are abstract and invisible, leading to low tangible gratification.

Saving Continues
Accumulation persists quietly in the background over days and weeks.

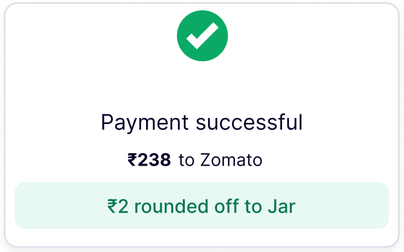
Only occasional checks
Users open the app rarely, mostly to monitor balance or during intervals.

Engagement Gap
Jar successfully removes the friction to save, but risks long-term churn.

Out of sight, out of mind
With zero need to act, users also lose a primary reason to check the app.

Saving happens outside Jar

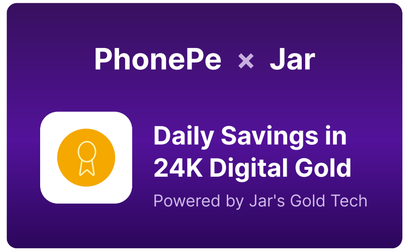
The trigger is the UPI payment, not the Jar app.



Once setup is complete, users don't need to open Jar for saving to continue.

Jar-powered saving is already inside PhonePe

PhonePe offers Daily Savings in 24K digital gold by partnering with Jar.

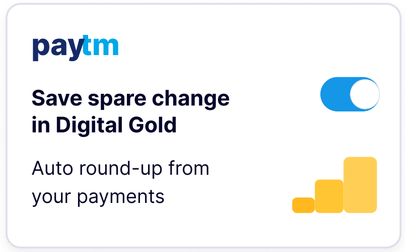


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Users can experience Jar-powered saving without needing the Jar app.

Round-off saving is not unique

Similar round-off / spare-change saving is already available on other payment apps like Paytm.

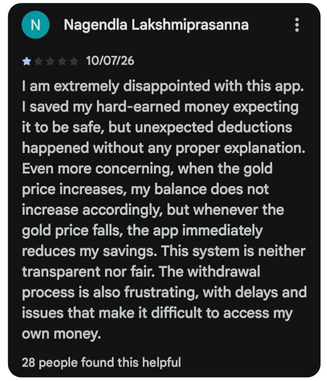


source

Gullak, Spare8, Pluto Money and others already offer the same auto-invest feature.

Users raise value and trust concerns

Reviews highlight concerns around transparency, charges, buy–sell spread and withdrawals.



source

Jar has built scale : the next opportunity is to make saving more engaging

COMPETITOR	APP CATEGORY	HOW GOLD-SAVING WORKS	GOLD PULLS USERS BACK?	REAL THREAT TO JAR
Jar	Single-purpose gold-savings app	UPI round-off → 24K gold, fully automatic	No : this is the exact gap your diagnosis is about	----
Gullak	Single-purpose gold-savings app (direct peer)	Rounds spend to nearest ₹10 → gold; also SIPs from ₹100/day	No : same passive design as Jar	**Moderate:** same mechanic, same weakness, but at a fraction of Jar's scale (₹2 crore FY24 revenue against ₹11.39 crore in losses, per Entrackr, versus Jar's roughly ₹208 crore operating revenue)
paytm	Broad payments super-app (UPI, bills, recharges, travel, etc.)	Every payment earns Gold Coins worth 1 percent of transaction value, redeemable at gold partners	No : the app is already opened daily for payments; gold is a passive loyalty kicker	**High:** Paytm doesn't have to solve Jar's engagement problem because it never had it; it borrows utility from payment use-cases

Source

A Glance at Jar

India-based gold micro-savings app Jar has turned profitable and is eyeing a 2026 IPO after revenue surged 49-fold to ₹24.5 billion (0.11), targeting low- to middle-income households. Jar has drawn over **35 million users across 12,000 pin codes, with 60% from smaller cities**, and more than 95% of its users are saving formally for the first time. Jar's current CEO is Nishchay AG (right), who co-founded the company with Misbah Ashraf (left).

Profitable for two straight quarters, Jar is already in talks with investment banks for its listing, according to TechCrunch. Its growth accelerated after shifting from third-party distribution to direct gold purchasing and custody with US-based cash management platform Brinks, while also expanding into jewellery sales and instant payments.

Source: TechCrunch

User Persona:



Age	19
Occupation	B.Tech Student
Saving Habit	Passive

Aarav - The Silent Saver

ABOUT

Aarav is a first-year B.Tech student living in a campus hostel. He pays for chai, canteen food and snacks through UPI, and switched on Jar's round-off after a friend's referral. He saves daily without noticing and rarely opens the app.

NEEDS

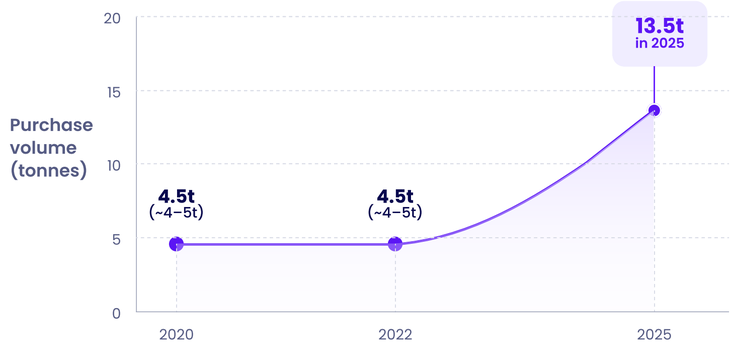
- A reason to open the app that gives value, not a nagging notification.
- Visible progress toward something he cares about, without changing how he pays.

PAIN POINTS

- Round-off runs in the background, so nothing changes on screen and Jar slips out of mind.
- Saves ₹3-₹10 at a time and can't see what it adds up to.
- Already opens a payments app daily, so Jar competes for his attention.

GOALS

- Save for a specific thing (a phone, a trip) without thinking about it.
- Open Jar 2-3 times a week because he wants to, not because he's prompted.



Source: World Gold Council; 2020 and 2022 estimates, 2025 estimate.

Market Opportunity

Digital gold purchase volume through UPI rose 377 percent in just 16 months, from 20.92 million transactions in April 2024 to 99.77 million in August 2025, according to NPCI data and digital gold has become one of the fastest-growing UPI merchant categories, joining NPCI's top 10 medium-volume categories in April 2024.

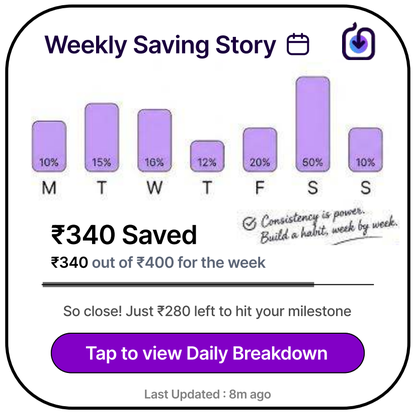
Source: World Gold Council; 2020 and 2022 estimates, 2025 estimate.

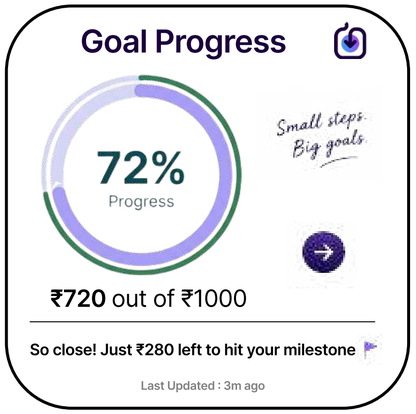
The user doesn't think: “I don't want to open Jar”. They often don't think about Jar at all: That’s what we need to change

Home-screen Widget

A dynamic Jar widget brings savings progress onto the user’s home screen, creating a natural reason to return without changing how saving works.







Key pain points solved

No trigger to return
Saving happens in UPI apps, not in Jar.

Widget keeps Jar visible in daily phone usage.

Progress is invisible
Small round-offs accumulate, but users don’t see what’s changing.

Shows recent savings and goal movement clearly.

No reason to open
Nothing is pending after setup.

Creates a voluntary reason to check progress (goals, milestones, insights).

New User Journey

From Silent Saving to Visible Progress

UPI Payment
User pays ₹47 on any UPI app

→ **Round-off**
Amount is rounded to nearest ₹10/₹100 and invested automatically
No action needed
Completely automatic once set up

→ **Home-screen Widget**
Widget shows a changing reason to check Jar (e.g., ₹18 saved today, 72% of goal)
Makes progress visible
Shows daily/goal/leaderboard/ weekly updates on home screen

→ **User Opens Jar**
Tap on widget deep links to relevant screen
Creates motivation
Gives a reason to open the app

→ **Meaningful Interaction**
User checks goal progress, leaderboard, portfolio or weekly story
Provides relevant value
Turns a quick check into a meaningful interaction
Happens outside the app
Triggered on other UPI apps (PhonePe, GPay, etc.)

Key metrics (to measure success)

Widget → App Click Through Rate.
% of widget users opening Jar

Meaningful opens / user / week
Target: 2–3

Widget opt-out rate
Should remain low (< 5–10%)

Trade-offs, limitations and mitigations

More opens vs. empty opens
Optimise for meaningful interaction, not just higher CTR.

Personalization vs. Privacy
Use only relevant savings/goal datawith user consent.

Frequent updates vs. Fatigue
Update on meaningful progress (e.g. daily/weekly), not every transaction.

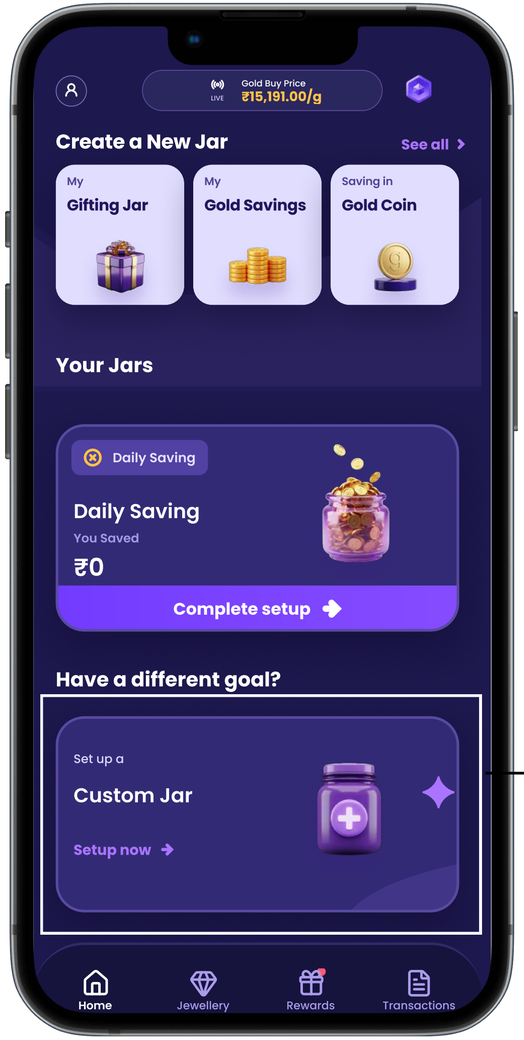
Small savings become meaningful when users can see what they're getting closer to.

Goal Progress Engine

Turn passive savings into visible progress by helping users set goals and see how their small savings are getting them closer, creating a stron emotional connection and reason to return.

Key pain points solved

No clear destination Users save, but don't see what it's for	Helps set a goal and see progress clearly
Progress feels too slow Small round-offs don't feel meaningful	Shows real progress with milestones and visuals.
No reason to return Nothing new happens after setup.	Milestones, updates and insights create ongoing engagement.



Custom goals turn passive savings into progress toward something users actually want.

Key metrics

Goal creation rate
% of active users creating a goal

Goal engagement
MAU checking goal progress (Target: 2–3/week)

Milestone conversion
% reaching 25% / 50% / 75% / 100%

Time to goal
Avg. time to reach goal after creation

New User Journey

Goal-Based Saving

UPI Payment
User makes a payment on any UPI app
→ **Happens outside the app**
Triggered on other UPI apps (PhonePe, GPay, etc.)

Round-off
Amount is rounded to nearest ₹10/₹100 and invested in digital gold
→ **No action needed**
Completely automatic once set up

Set a Goal
User sets a personal goal (e.g., Headphones ₹2,000)
→ **Gives a purpose**
Turns saving into a meaningful outcome

Track Progress
Every UPI payment adds automatically. User sees ₹ saved,% of goal and days to go.
→ **Creates a reason to return**
Visible progress and estimated time to reach

Goal Achieved
User reaches the goal earlier or on time and sets a new goal.
→ **Completes and continues**
Reaches goal and sets next goal

Trade-offs, limitations and mitigations

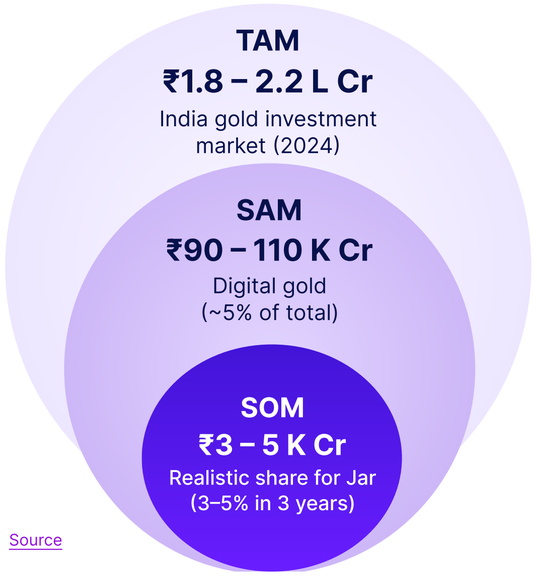
Goal fatigue
Allow flexible goals, reminders only for meaningful updates.

More opens vs. empty opens
Focus on meaningful interactions (milestones, insights), not just opens.

Unrealistic goals
Suggest goal amounts and timelines based on saving behaviour.

A small lift in engagement can create meaningful business impact

Market Opportunity (Digital Gold in India)



Source

TAM
Total gold investment market in India
~₹1.8 – 2.2 L Cr (2024)

SAM
Digital gold market (~5% of total)
~₹90 – 110 K Cr

SOM
Realistic share for Jar (3–5% in 3 years)
~₹3 – 5 K Cr

Incremental Impact from Proposed Solutions (6-month estimate)

Solution 1
Home-screen Widget

Brings Jar back into the user's daily environment and drives meaningful opens.

Incremental active users (MAU)	+8–12%
Meaningful opens per user / week	+1–2
Increase in savings per active user / month	+15–25%
Estimated incremental AUM (6 months)	₹250 – 400 Cr
Estimated incremental revenue (@2% take rate)	₹5 – 8 Cr

Solution 2
Goal Progress Engine

Helps users set goals and see progress, increasing retention and savings per user.

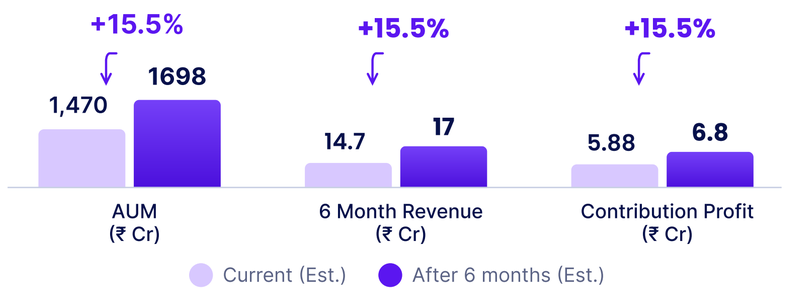
Increase in user retention (30/90-day)	+10–20 pp
Goal creation rate (% of MAU)	+2–3×
Increase in savings per active user / month	+30–50%
Estimated incremental AUM (6 months)	₹210 – 350 Cr
Estimated incremental revenue (@2% take rate)	₹4 – 7 Cr

Key Assumptions

Current MAU	3.5M
Avg. savings per active user / month	₹350
Revenue take rate (on AUM)	~2% p.a.
Contribution margin	~40%
Time horizon for impact	6 months (initial rollout)

Source

Combined Financial Impact (6 months)



Source

Key Takeaways

Large headroom: Digital gold is a fast-growing market with ~₹90–110 K Cr addressable size.

Even a **modest** 30%+ uplift in AUM can add ~₹9 Cr revenue in 6 months.

Both solutions are **complementary:**
Widget drives re-entry, Goals drive retention.

Scalable model: Higher engagement leads to higher AUM and revenue without major change in unit economics.

Jar

Key Business Metrics: Measuring Engagement That Drives Value

North Star Metric

Meaningful Weekly Active Savers (MWAS)

% of weekly active savers who complete at least one meaningful progress action (e.g., check goal, view progress, milestone, insight).

Why this metric?

It captures true multi-feature engagement and correlates with higher retention, savings and long-term value for Jar.

Engagement Metrics

Are users actually using the new experience?

	Target
Meaningful interactions per user / week Widget views, goal checks, milestone views, insights	2 - 3+
Progress interaction rate % of MAU checking savings/ goal progress	20%+
30-day return rate % of users who return within 30 days after first interaction	10 – 20%+

Business Outcome Metrics

Is engagement translating into value for Jar?

	Target
Monthly Active Users (MAU) % of users active per month	+8 – 12%
Avg. savings per active user Monthly savings via round-offs and goals	+15 – 30%
Goal completion rate % of users completing a goal	2 – 3x
AUM per active saver Average gold holdings per active user	+15 – 30%

Things to Watch

Engagement should never come at the cost of saving or trust.

₹ saved per user	Saving frequency	Opt-out rate	Trust & complaints
Must remain stable or increase	No decline after introducing the new features	Keep widget + notification opt-outs low	No increase in complaints around charges, withdrawals or misleading information

Overall Business Impact (6-month estimate)

If key metrics improve as expected, the features can drive meaningful business impact.

+8 – 12%	+25 – 40%	+25 – 40%
MAU	**Incremental AUM**	**Incremental Annual Revenue**
~3.5M → ~3.8 – 3.9M	≈₹1,470 Cr → ≈₹1,840 - 2,060 Cr	≈₹29 Cr → ≈₹36 – 41 Cr (at ~2% take rate)

APPENDIX

Jar

- TechCrunch: Jar turns profitable by helping millions save in gold (35M+ users, 12K pin codes, 95%+ first-time savers) - Link
- Business Standard: Jar FY25 results, revenue surges and reaches profitability - Link
- PhonePe: PhonePe partners with Jar to launch Daily Savings in digital gold - Link
- Jar: Digital Gold product page - Link

Competitors

- Gullak: Digital Gold product page - Link
- Inc42: Gold investment startup Gullak raises $7.5 Mn - Link
- Entrepreneur India: Gullak raises $7.5 Mn Series A led by Chiratae - Link
- Paytm press release: Gold Coins, every payment earns 1% in Gold Coins convertible into Digital Gold (Sep 2025) - Link
- Spare8: Investing regularly with Spare8 (round-up digital gold savings model) - Link

Market size and growth

- World Gold Council: India Gold Market Update, January 2026 - Link
- World Gold Council: Gold Demand Trends, India investment, full year 2024 - Link
- World Gold Council: Gold investment market and financialisation, India Gold Market Series - Link
- Economic Times: UPI push sparks 377% rise in digital gold in 16 months - Link
- IndBiz: Digital gold transactions surge 377% as UPI drives shift in investment - Link
- Financial Express: Actual gold too hot to handle, buyers turn to digital - Link

Regulation and payments infrastructure

- SEBI: Caution to public regarding dealing in digital gold (Nov 2025) - Link
- NPCI: UPI ecosystem statistics - Link
- NPCI press release: AutoPay facility on UPI for recurring payments (2020) - Link

APPENDIX

- Gold Investment Startup Gullak Raises $7.5 Mn - Link
- Jar funding/investors - Link
- Gold savings app Gullak raises $7.5 Mn led by Chiratae - Link
- India Digital Gold and WealthTech Platforms Market - Link
- Gold Demand Trends: India Focus Q1 2026 - Link
- Gold investment market and financialisation: India gold market series - Link
- Digital gold rises 377% in 16 months with UPI push - Link
- Jar FY25 results: revenue surges, reaches profitability (Business Standard) - Link
- 15 Best Digital Gold Investment Apps in India, 2025 (EaseMyDeal) - Link
- Jar Fintech Achieves Profitability with Digital Gold Savings - Link
- Gullak - About the company - Link
- Reddit r/personalfinanceindia: user discussion on digital gold apps - Link
- Reddit r/personalfinanceindia: user discussion on digital gold apps - Link
- Reddit r/personalfinanceindia: user discussion on digital gold apps - Link
- Reddit r/Advice: user discussion - Link
- LinkedIn post (Deepika Agrawal): Jar hidden charges and unfair pricing - Link
- Global Fintech Insider: Jar's golden IPO plans (newsletter, 30 Sep 2025) - Link
- Wealthtech startup Jar turns profitable in H1 2025 (Business Review) - Link
- https://www.phonepe.com/press/phonepe-partners-with-jar-to-launch-daily-savings-in-digital-gold/

Thank You